

Though the 8010 sold only 25,000 units, it brought to the fore many innovative features that have been improved upon in the computers of today. WYSIWYG editing, Ethernet and networking services, commands like Print and File, and its window-based GUI set benchmarks for the rest of the computer industry.

It does seem that the 8010 was ahead of its time. It will also be remembered for inspiring Apple's Lisa and Macintosh computers and Microsoft's Windows, among many others.

May: Colour Comes Home

The VIC-20 was the first ever colour-display home computer. It didn't include the display, of course; it could be hooked up to a monitor or TV or any kind of display unit. Launched in May by Commodore Business Machines, it went



An ad for the VIC-20

on to sell a million units. The reasons behind its success were its 8-bit memory and its colour display, and the fact that it cost \$299.95 then (Rs 16,000 today). Its main competition at the time was with the BBC Micro and Spectrum series of computers, which were also targeted at home users—with attractive pricing and good colour displays.

The VIC-20 was earlier called “Vixen”; however, this name was inappropriate in Germany, its second-largest market, because it sounded like *wichsen*, slang for “masturbate”. Therefore it was decided that the computer would be named “VIC”, after the on-board Video Interface Chip.

Due to its small memory and low-resolution display compared to other computers of its time—which were running on 4 MHz processors and 16 KB of memory—the VIC-20 was mainly used for educational software and games. These were available on car-